



Make your own games

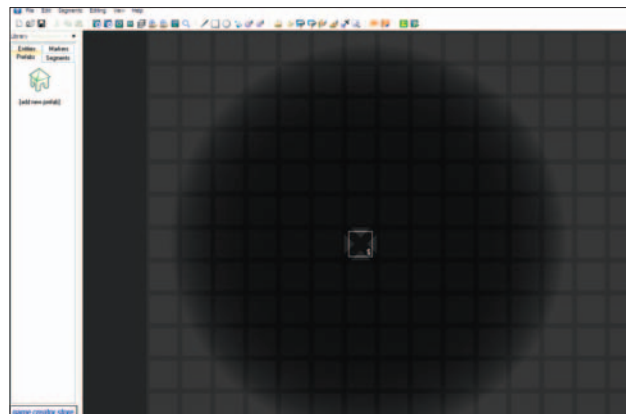
Aditya Madanapalle

Here, we discuss methods to create your own simple game. Before you start, you need to invest a lot of time and effort. Even a simple game has to be tweaked many times over to gain perfection. You don't necessarily need have any prior knowledge of programming. This is a guide to get started, your imagination can take you much further.

Part I: Make a game using FPS Creator

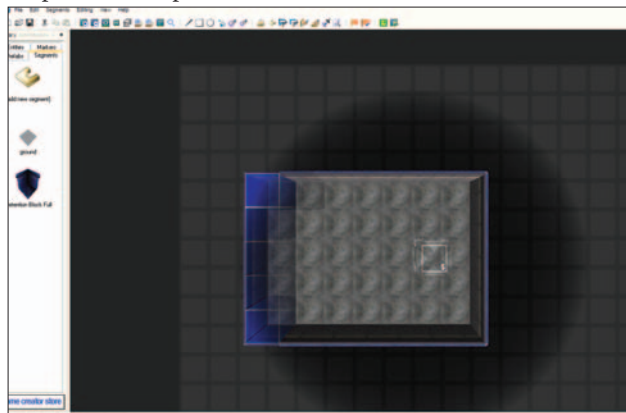
FPS Creator is a simple and fun game creator with a quick approach. You can download it at www.fpscreator.com. The web site also sells model packs that can be used with the creator, and they have a range of interesting items, backgrounds and characters. FPS creator allows you to create an environment for playing, set points for picking up health and ammunition, and locate enemies around the map. You can also waypoint enemies to give them movement, which is a very basic form of artificial intelligence.

The opening screen of FPS Creator has a library toolbar to the right and a grid in the main window. We will be "painting" objects, entities, and segments of the map on this grid. To move



Opening screen

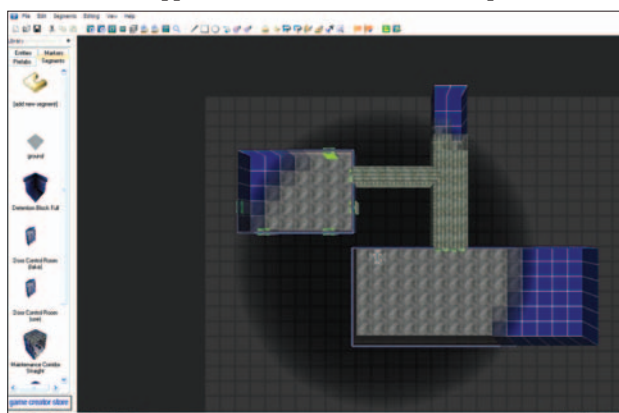
around the grid, use the arrow keys. To go up or down a layer, or level, use the plus [+] and minus [-] keys. You can use this method to create multiple levels in the same map. To zoom in or out, use the mouse wheel. Zooming and changing the levels is not the same operation. You start at a neutral level, and can either dig deeper, or build up.



Simple room

By default, the 'prefrab' tab is selected. This is a library of pre-fabricated structures that can be added directly to the map. To create your own structures from scratch, go to the segments tab, and click on 'add new segment'. There are two sets of segments, one with a sci-fi theme, the other with a WWII theme. A typical brush will paint a floor, the walls, and the ceiling. Adjoining blocks will be automatically joined. There are also floor only, and ceiling-only brushes available. Ignore the ramps, steps and platform brushes for now. Choose a room brush, and start painting.

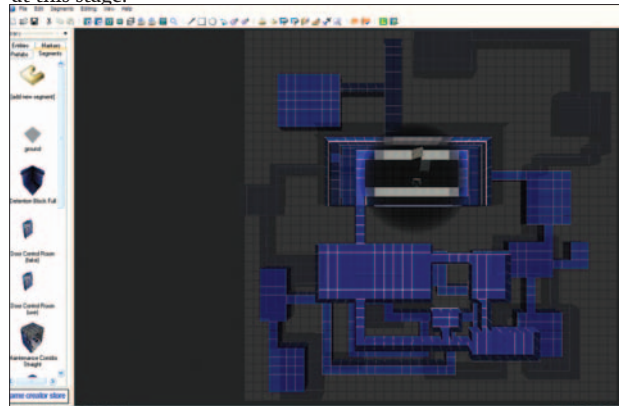
This creates a simple room. To create some kind of an exit from the room, go to Segments > Sci-fi > Scenery and select one of the doors. The 'automatic' doors will open when the character approaches. The 'use' doors will open when the



Corridors and faked rooms

user presses the action key for opening the door. The fake doors will not open, and as such don't lead to anything. First, select the door; to rotate the door while placing it, use the [R] key. We will create a corridor leading out from the door. Go to Segment > Sci-Fi > corridors. Select a corridor and paint them, along with a turn segment or two if you want. Lead the corridor into another room, and place doors on that room too.

Moving to advanced game building; after selecting a room brush, go to the Segments menu and select one of the options. For example, Segments > Paint Only Walls adds walls without the floor or ceiling. This allows you to create openings into upper levels, or create rooms that have high ceilings. Go to Segments > Sci-Fi > Platforms for selecting staircases that lead to the upper levels. Use all the imagination you have got at this stage.



Complicated levels